Dear Editor,

We are pleased to submit our manuscript entitled **"Joint Discovery of Dense MLP Topology and Optimizer via a Two-Phase Genetic Algorithm on CPU"** for consideration in Applied Soft Computing.

This paper introduces a highly efficient sequential two-phase evolutionary framework to discover both a Dense MLP topology and a custom optimization rule on a standard CPU. A key highlight of our work is its alignment with the Green AI philosophy, achieving competitive results with standard Adam on most configurations while minimizing the computational footprint compared to typical GPU-heavy NAS methods. We also introduce Soft Weight Smoothing to prevent population collapse during the genetic search.

To ensure reproducibility, the complete source code and data are available at: https://github.com/mehrjoot42/Evolutionary-NAS-Paper.

We confirm that this manuscript has not been published elsewhere and is not under consideration by another journal. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission.

Sincerely,
Ahmad Mehrjoo